Ford Motor Company

Frank M. Ligon
Director
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Ford Customer Service Division

Ford Motor Company
P. O. Box 1904
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June 2002

TO: All Ford and Lincoln Mercury Dealers

SUBJECT: Emissions Recall 02E21: Certain 2002 Thunderbird Vehicles - Catalyst Monitor Sensor Connector Inspection

REF: Dealer Announcement dated 10/26/01, Special Handling Procedure

AFFECTED VEHICLES

Certain 2002 Thunderbird vehicles built at the Wixom Assembly Plant from February 13, 2002 through April 19, 2002.

REASON FOR THIS RECALL

In some of the affected vehicles, the left and right Catalyst Monitor Sensor (CMS) connectors may have been reversed during supplier component assembly. As a result vehicle emissions may exceed Federal standards.

SERVICE ACTION

Before demonstrating or delivering any of the vehicles involved in this recall, the dealer must inspect all of the affected vehicles to make sure that the left and right CMS connectors are attached to their respective catalysts. If the connectors are found to be reversed, some disassembly of the harness will be necessary to switch the position of the connectors. All of the affected vehicles in your inventory as well as vehicles that have been delivered to customers must be inspected and, if necessary, corrected.

NOTE: The State of California and the Commonwealth of Massachusetts require the completion of emission recall repairs prior to vehicle registration renewal. For vehicles registered in these states, please provide the owner with a Vehicle Emission Recall Proof of Correction certificate after the repair has been performed. (These certificates may be obtained by contacting your regional office).

CUSTOMER NOTIFICATION

Owners of record will be notified beginning June 21, 2002.

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PLEASE NOTE

Correct all vehicles in stock before delivery. Vehicles with reversed CMS connectors lack a necessary element of emission control design, and vehicles with this error delivered to customers will need to be recalled. Sale of uncorrected vehicles to customers could lead to penalties under the Clean Air Act.

SPECIAL HANDLING PROCEDURE

The Special Handling Procedure has been activated for all Thunderbird owners affected by this program. Please see dealer announcement dated 10/26/01, Special Handling Procedure. This special handling procedure provides additional allowance to enable dealers to offer owners convenient vehicle handling.

Ford Motor Company is asking for your support and the cooperation of your sales and service teams to make this a positive experience for our Thunderbird customers, many of whom are new to the Ford family.

ATTACHMENTS

Attachment I:	Administrative Information
Attachment II:	Labor Allowances and Parts Ordering Information
Attachment III:	Technical Information
Customer Letters	

QUESTIONS?

Claims Information:……	1-800-423-8851
Online Involved Unit Listings:…..……..	1-800-555-9601
Other Recall (Dealers Only) Questions:……	1-800-325-5621

Sincerely,

Frank M. Ligon

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Director
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EMISSIONS RECALL 02E21
Certain 2002 Thunderbird Vehicles
Catalyst Monitor Sensor Connector Inspection

OASIS

You must use OASIS to determine if a vehicle is eligible for this recall.

PROMPTLY CORRECT

Promptly correct all affected vehicles on your dealer Online Involved Unit Listing available on QCDealer.com. Also, correct other affected vehicles identified in OASIS which are brought to your dealership.

DEALER-OWNER CONTACT

Note: Owners should receive the "Special Handling Procedure." To familiarize yourself, please review "Special Handling Procedure" before calling customers.

Immediately contact any affected owner whose name is not on the list but identified in OASIS. Give the owner a copy of the Owner Letter and schedule a service date.

NOTE: These dealer listings may contain customer names and addresses obtained from Motor Vehicle Registration Records. The use of such motor vehicle registration data for any purpose other than in connection with this recall is a violation of law in several states/provinces/countries. Accordingly, you must limit the use of this listing to the follow-up necessary to complete this action.

REGIONAL CONTACT

Advise regional office if an owner:

- cannot be contacted.
- does not make a service date.

CLAIMS PREPARATION AND SUBMISSION

- Enter claims using DWE.
- Refer to ACESII manual for claims preparation and submission information.

To claim for "Special Handling", follow the instructions on page two of dealer announcement dated 10/26/01.

OWNER REFUNDS

Ford Motor Company will only refund owner-paid repairs made before the date of the owner letter (or after the date of the owner letter if an emergency repair was made away from the servicing dealer). Refer to ACESII manual for refund information.

RENTAL CARS

See "Special Handling Guidelines" for claiming a rental vehicle under this program.

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EMISSIONS RECALL 02E21
Certain 2002 Thunderbird Vehicles
Catalyst Monitor Sensor Connector Inspection

LABOR ALLOWANCES

Description	Labor Operation	Labor Time
Inspect Catalyst Monitor Sensor Connectors	02E21A	0.3 Hours
Inspect and Correct Catalyst Monitor Sensor Connectors	02E21B	0.3 Hours
Special Handling	Misc. Expense Code "SCHP"	See Special Handling
Administrative Allowance	Misc. Expense Code "ADMIN"	0.1 Hour

PARTS REQUIREMENTS / ORDERING INFORMATION

Part Number	Description	Quantity
FPS-8262	Authorized Modifications Label*	1

***** Label orders come in packages of 25.

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